Maine SLD Case Lab — participant worksheet

Fictional educator practice • Version 1.1.0 • Reviewed 2026-10-02

Participant responses only. This worksheet contains no facilitator key and makes no actual eligibility determination.

Alex, Grade 4: evidence and instruction need

Alex is age 9, in Grade 4, English-dominant, with 96% attendance. Appropriate core instruction and 12 weeks of explicit decoding intervention (4 x 30 minutes weekly) have documented implementation. Reading increases from 54 to 61 correct words per minute; the fictional grade benchmark is 110.

With audio text, Alex answers grade-level content questions independently. Independent reading stays slow with decoding errors despite extra time. Family reports that Alex discusses stories heard aloud but needs help reading homework directions.

Assume valid testing by qualified evaluators, a documented review finding no primary exclusionary cause, normal vision/hearing screening, and no educationally relevant medical finding. The full score record is simulated for discussion; original reporting and scoring detail remain intentional verification gaps.

Selected findings

Alex is age 9, in Grade 4, English-dominant, with 96% attendance. Appropriate core instruction and 12 weeks of explicit decoding intervention (4 x 30 minutes weekly) have documented implementation. Reading increases from 54 to 61 correct words per minute; the fictional grade benchmark is 110.

review: Participant alex selected observation.

Form reasoning

Q1 · Achievement

Not yet recorded

[Reasoning not recorded]

Q2 · Appropriate instruction

Not yet recorded

[Reasoning not recorded]

Q3 · Primary causes

Not yet recorded

[Reasoning not recorded]

Q4 · Relevant pattern

Not yet recorded

[Reasoning not recorded]

Q5 · Observation narrative

Narrative not yet recorded

[Reasoning not recorded]

Q6 · Medical findings narrative
Narrative not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q7 · Validity / qualifications
Not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q8 · SLD conclusion
More evidence needed
Participant alex Q8 reasoning.

Q9 · Instruction needed
More evidence needed
Participant alex Q9 reasoning.

Q9 summary
Participant alex summary.

Evidence still needed
Participant alex evidence request.

Family explanation
Participant alex family explanation. literal family note

Multilingual learner transfer
Participant alex language evidence.

Alex variation: general education is adequate
Use the same Alex case and score record. Change only the premise about the need for special education. Assume the full review still establishes SLD, but the complete evaluation now demonstrates that general education interventions and accommodations adequately address Alex's learning needs.

Selected findings
Use the same Alex case and score record. Change only the premise about the need for special education. review: Participant alex-general-ed-adequate selected observation.

Form reasoning

Q1 · Achievement
Not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q2 · Appropriate instruction
Not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q3 · Primary causes
Not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q4 · Relevant pattern
Not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q5 · Observation narrative
Narrative not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q6 · Medical findings narrative
Narrative not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q7 · Validity / qualifications
Not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q8 · SLD conclusion
More evidence needed
Participant alex-general-ed-adequate Q8 reasoning.

Q9 · Instruction needed
More evidence needed
Participant alex-general-ed-adequate Q9 reasoning.

Q9 summary
Participant alex-general-ed-adequate summary.

Evidence still needed
Participant alex-general-ed-adequate evidence request.

Family explanation
Participant alex-general-ed-adequate family explanation. literal family note

Multilingual learner transfer
Participant alex-general-ed-adequate language evidence.

Jordan, Grade 5: achievement and family concerns

Jordan is age 10. The family reports homework frustration and difficulty remembering multistep directions. For this exercise, assume a valid, comprehensive evaluation using appropriate achievement assessments, classroom measures, representative work and teacher/family information.

The team reviews all eight academic areas. Multiple sources show adequate achievement for age AND meeting grade-level standards independently in every area. One valid working-memory measure gives a standard score of 78.

All details are fictional. Passing grades or promotion alone would not establish the stated achievement evidence. The conclusion concerns SLD and does not dismiss other suspected disabilities or end appropriate support.

Selected findings

Jordan is age 10. The family reports homework frustration and difficulty remembering multistep directions. For this exercise, assume a valid, comprehensive evaluation using appropriate achievement assessments, classroom measures, representative work and teacher/family information.

review: Participant jordan selected observation.

Form reasoning

Q1 · Achievement

Not yet recorded

[Reasoning not recorded]

Q2 · Appropriate instruction

Not yet recorded

[Reasoning not recorded]

Q3 · Primary causes

Not yet recorded

[Reasoning not recorded]

Q4 · Relevant pattern

Not yet recorded

[Reasoning not recorded]

Q5 · Observation narrative

Narrative not yet recorded

[Reasoning not recorded]

Q6 · Medical findings narrative

Narrative not yet recorded

[Reasoning not recorded]

Q7 · Validity / qualifications
Not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q8 · SLD conclusion
More evidence needed
Participant jordan Q8 reasoning.

Q9 · Instruction needed
More evidence needed
Participant jordan Q9 reasoning.

Q9 summary
Participant jordan summary.

Evidence still needed
Participant jordan evidence request.

Family explanation
Participant jordan family explanation. literal family note

Multilingual learner transfer
Participant jordan language evidence.

Marisol, Grade 4: multilingual access and evidence gaps

Marisol is age 9 years, 10 months, in Grade 4. She uses Spanish with her family and English and Spanish at school. Her family describes detailed Spanish storytelling, an interest in science and persistent difficulty reading unfamiliar words in Spanish. She explains mathematical reasoning well with diagrams. She attended Spanish-medium school in Grades 1-2, with a four-month interruption during a school closure, and entered English-medium instruction in Grade 3. Prior literacy-instruction records are incomplete.

The current school documents regular attendance and scheduled ESOL instruction. The ESOL teacher reports stronger English listening and discussion with visual/context support than independent academic reading and written explanations. English development differs across tasks and domains. The language-access plan is available, but classroom implementation logs and the earlier school's instruction and intervention records have not yet been reviewed. These gaps do not establish whether inadequate instruction primarily explains the reading concern.

During an English science lesson, Marisol explains the concept using a diagram and partner discussion, but has difficulty independently reading the written directions. In a brief Spanish reading sample arranged by qualified bilingual staff, she hesitates on unfamiliar words; no age/grade comparison, systematic response-to-teaching record or comprehensive Spanish literacy assessment accompanies that sample. Her family requests an evaluation and participation through a qualified Spanish interpreter. The team has begun the evaluation process while language and reading supports continue.

An English-only assessment summary lists low reading performance but does not document the assessment's linguistic suitability, norming applicability, administration adaptations or interpretation limits. No standardized scores from that summary are supplied for this practice record. Vision/hearing screening reports, the complete medical history and a full review across the academic areas are also absent from the excerpt. The record raises a reading concern and an assessment-validity question; it establishes neither SLD nor a language-only explanation.

Selected findings

Marisol is age 9 years, 10 months, in Grade 4. She uses Spanish with her family and English and Spanish at school. Her family describes detailed Spanish storytelling, an interest in science and persistent difficulty reading unfamiliar words in Spanish. She explains mathematical reasoning well with diagrams. She attended Spanish-medium school in Grades 1-2, with a four-month interruption during a school closure, and entered English-medium instruction in Grade 3. Prior literacy-instruction records are incomplete.
review: Participant marisol selected observation.

Form reasoning

Q1 · Achievement

Not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q2 · Appropriate instruction

Not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q3 · Primary causes

Not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q4 · Relevant pattern

Not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q5 · Observation narrative

Narrative not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q6 · Medical findings narrative

Narrative not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q7 · Validity / qualifications

Not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q8 · SLD conclusion
More evidence needed
Participant marisol Q8 reasoning.

Q9 · Instruction needed
More evidence needed
Participant marisol Q9 reasoning.

Q9 summary
Participant marisol summary.

Evidence still needed
Participant marisol evidence request.

Family explanation
Participant marisol family explanation. literal family note

Multilingual learner transfer
Participant marisol language evidence.

Taylor, Grade 5: progress and the instruction it requires

Taylor is age 10 years, 7 months, in Grade 5 and receives reading instruction under an IEP. A comprehensive reevaluation includes appropriate achievement and psychological-processing assessments, repeated progress measures, classroom observations, work samples and student/family input. The qualified evaluators document a relevant pattern across the required evidence streams and continuing SLD affecting basic reading and reading fluency. Appropriate core instruction, intervention implementation and a documented review of each primary-cause factor are verified.

Taylor contributes thoughtful ideas to class discussion and meets many science and social-studies assignment expectations with accessible audio/text, previewed vocabulary and extra reading time. Independent unfamiliar-word reading and connected-text fluency remain below age and Grade 5 expectations across valid assessment, classroom work and repeated reading measures. Successful supported content work does not show adequate independent achievement in every academic area.

Taylor's progress measures show improvement during explicitly sequenced decoding instruction: smaller teaching steps, carefully selected word patterns, cumulative practice, immediate corrective feedback and flexible pacing adjusted from ongoing error analysis. Implementation and longitudinal transfer records document that these adaptations address Taylor's disability-related learning needs. Appropriate general education interventions and accommodations have not adequately addressed those needs without the specified teaching adaptations. The full reevaluation establishes that the adaptations remain necessary for access to and progress in the curriculum.

The family asks whether better report-card grades mean that the reading instruction can end. The team has not withdrawn necessary instruction to test that idea. It reviews existing instruction, implementation, independent performance, supported performance and generalization data. No educationally relevant

medical finding is reported in the complete reviewed record. The few simulated scores below illustrate that record; they do not determine eligibility, calculate composites or replace the full evaluation.

Selected findings

Taylor is age 10 years, 7 months, in Grade 5 and receives reading instruction under an IEP. A comprehensive reevaluation includes appropriate achievement and psychological-processing assessments, repeated progress measures, classroom observations, work samples and student/family input. The qualified evaluators document a relevant pattern across the required evidence streams and continuing SLD affecting basic reading and reading fluency. Appropriate core instruction, intervention implementation and a documented review of each primary-cause factor are verified.
review: Participant taylor selected observation.

Form reasoning

Q1 · Achievement

Not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q2 · Appropriate instruction

Not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q3 · Primary causes

Not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q4 · Relevant pattern

Not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q5 · Observation narrative

Narrative not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q6 · Medical findings narrative

Narrative not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q7 · Validity / qualifications

Not yet recorded
[Reasoning not recorded]

Q8 · SLD conclusion

More evidence needed
Participant taylor Q8 reasoning.

Q9 · Instruction needed

More evidence needed

Participant taylor Q9 reasoning.

Q9 summary

Participant taylor summary.

Evidence still needed

Participant taylor evidence request.

Family explanation

Participant taylor family explanation. literal family note

Multilingual learner transfer

Participant taylor language evidence.